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A short pre-read on hiring a Founding Design Engineer

I have over a decade of experience working primarily in B2B SaaS and developer tools. More recently, I've been building up a software factory of personal projects, end to end. I'm at home on the Cloudflare platform but quickly onboarding to exe.

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Why exe

You're keeping compute primitives lean and handing an open platform to builders. I think exe can capture indie builders such as myself, as well as enterprise teams.

The product design hat

I was the early product designer at WorkOS and LaunchDarkly, and joined both at Series A where I owned the design debt while keeping pace with new features.

That early stage — a lot of surface, few people, high cadence — is where I do my best work. My professional past is mostly making deep infrastructure accessible and feel intuitive.

AI has shifted product but I believe by enabling other functions to ship code, it's mostly for the better.

Learning the exe way

After scraping exe's blog, I questioned my own recent defacto adoption of Tailwind. I went back to a decade old CSS variables library of mine and distilled it into something for AI. I came up with Largen, a property algebra for CSS. *Surprisingly, both the .dev and npm names were available.*

There's no build step but also no utility classes. ~2.35kb, zero runtime JavaScript. It ships the machinery to write your own dozen components instead of adopting large libraries. It also carries an MCP interface hosted on exe, so agents can build and evaluate.

Hosted on exe: largen.exe.xyz · github.com/vikramrojo/largen

largen

contractaxesauthoringcomponentsmcpmigratingplay

A property algebra for CSS.

14 custom-property slots, four axes, one universal paint rule — and the components are yours. Plain CSS: no build step, no preprocessor, no plugin.

[Read the contract](#)[MCP server](#)[Playground](#)

A complete component

```
@layer largen.components {
  .notification, notification {
    --bg: var(--tone-soft);
    --fg: var(--tone-ink);
    --border-width: 0 0 0 3px;
    --border-color: var(--tone);
    --border-style: solid;
    --radius: var(--radius-md);
    --pad: .75em 1em;
    --gap: .75em;
    display: grid;
    grid-template-columns: auto 1fr;
    align-items: center;
  }
}
```

Seven tones, four variants, five sizes, every state and both themes — none of which it mentions. Everything above the component row is already solved, so the component is the only thing left to write.

It is not a catalog

Most CSS libraries ship components and ask you to configure them. largen ships the algebra underneath components and expects you to write your own, named in your application's own language — `.entry-card`, not `.card-lg-bordered`.

Reference components — largen

largen.exe.xyz/docs/components.html

Feedback

alert

A message reporting a state. Use with a tone.

Your export finished.

```
.alert, l-alert {
  --bg: var(--tone-soft);
  --fg: var(--tone-ink);
  --border-color: var(--tone-line);
  --border-width: var(--hairline);
  --border-style: solid;
  --radius: var(--radius-md);
  --pad: 0.85em 1em;
  --gap: 0.75em;
  display: grid;
  grid-template-columns: auto 1fr auto;
  align-items: center;
}
```

badge

A short inline label or count.

beta

```
.badge, l-badge {
  --bg: var(--tone-soft);
  --fg: var(--tone-ink);
  --border-color: var(--tone-line);
  --border-width: var(--hairline);
  --border-style: solid;
  --radius: 2em;
  --pad: 0.15em 0.6em;
  --gap: 0.3em;
  --font-size: calc(0.78rem * var(--scale));
  --weight: var(--weight-medium);
  display: inline-flex;
  align-items: center;
  inline-size: fit-content;
  white-space: nowrap;
}
```

dot

A bare status dot. No content.

```
.dot, l-dot {
  --bg: var(--tone-soft);
  --fg: var(--tone-ink);
  --border-color: var(--tone-line);
  --border-width: var(--hairline);
  --border-style: solid;
  --radius: 2em;
  --pad: 0.15em 0.6em;
  --gap: 0.3em;
  --font-size: calc(0.78rem * var(--scale));
  --weight: var(--weight-medium);
  display: inline-flex;
  align-items: center;
  inline-size: fit-content;
  white-space: nowrap;
}
```

My software factory, and its ceiling

I build with an open-source agent harness, Paseo that felt more responsive to developers. I also rely heavily on Openspec to make technical decisions, prioritize and track work. I follow all this up with a QA gate before commits. It seems to work for indie development.

But it's solo, and it stops at Cloudflare and Swift. exe is the horizon past that: collaboration, and deployment that isn't only mine.

Proof, shipped

Lango1 — on-device language trainer. No cloud, no dependencies. In TestFlight.

Wondo — interactive-story marketplace. Its own brand, a gameplay component library, Cloudflare AI agents.

Finsum — budgeting app on my cross-platform scaffold.
Staging build on exe with a Paseo daemon running.

5:08

⏸

Lupita Waitress

⋮

¿Mesa para

cuántas

personas?

🔊

💬

Mesa para cuatro personas, por favor.

🔊

✔

Great start, keep practicing!

Perfecto,

les

doy

una

mesa

junto

a

la

ventana.

¿Qué

van

a

tomar?

🔊

💬

Yo quiero una cerveza

🔊

✔

Great start, keep going!

¿Ya

saben

qué

van

a

pedir?

■

💬

◆ 4 pts · 3 turns · 2:24

⚙

Type your reply...

↑

🎤

Wondo

GutenbuchOutlineDiscussionsMeDiscordSign inWrite

Interactive stories worth replaying.

Buy and sell interactive stories.

Read a sample

Write

Try [a classic story](#), rewritten in Wondo Ink.

§ WHAT WE'RE BUILDING

Everything you need to ship a serialized gamebook, in one place.

Building a gamebook today means hacking together a site, payments, and subscribers. We collapsed it into one platform.

* Upcoming features

I.

Publish rich storyworlds.

Branching, state, conditions

II.

Built on Ink opensource.

The language behind community

III.

Checkout that pays you in full.*

Get paid for your work

IV.

Email between drops.*

Subscriber lists you can build

Finsum

Log in →

A WEEKLY MONEY PRACTICE

Map your money *before you spend.*

A spending coach that you command. Map assets, debts and goals in minutes without spreadsheets and bank logins. Find your baseline and achieve your financial goals.

Start free →

FREE · NO BANK LINKING · YOUR DATA STAYS YOURS

MONDAY, JUL 20

+ \$650

💰 \$750/wk	standing	+ \$750
🏠 @cc = -\$2,000	created	-
🏠 @cc == -\$1,000		-
🔄 \$50 @cc	\$950 to go	-\$50
🏠 @cc == -\$1,000 by Aug 1, 2026		-
🍷 \$50 @dining	coffee	-\$50
🍷 @boat = \$0	created	-
🍷 @boat == \$2,000 by Dec 1, 2026		-
Weekly @base remaining:		\$650
› History		
Map your money		

Exe extends solo work

One person, one machine, one cloud is the whole limit of what I run today. And it's entirely dependent on Cloudflare workers and services.

Persistent, shareable VMs turn that into something a team builds on together without hassles.

Closing with how I design today

Spec-first, upfront prototype planning with lots of QA after. Once the product is architected, I continuously revise and improve the surface to have it live up to the product promise.

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